

NIKHIL KESARKAR

Senior Data Engineer | Azure | Databricks | Spark
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 4+ years designing and optimizing cloud-scale data pipelines on Azure Data Factory, Azure Synapse Analytics, Azure Databricks, and Microsoft Fabric. Delivered ETL/ELT, Lakehouse, and data warehousing solutions for clients across consulting, manufacturing, and healthcare. Strong with Spark and distributed processing, Delta Lake performance tuning, and CI/CD automation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Data Platforms: Microsoft Azure, Azure Data Factory (ADF), Azure Synapse Analytics, Azure Databricks, Microsoft Fabric, OneLake, ADLS Gen2, Azure SQL Database

Data Engineering: ETL/ELT, Data Pipelines, Lakehouse & Medallion Architecture, Data Warehousing, Data Modeling, Slowly Changing Dimensions (SCD), Data Migration, Data Governance, Unity Catalog, Data Quality

Big Data & Performance: Apache Spark, PySpark, Spark SQL, Distributed Computing, Delta Lake, Delta Live Tables (DLT), Spark Structured Streaming, Performance Tuning, Z-Ordering, Partitioning, Parquet

Programming & DevOps: Python, SQL, Object-Oriented Programming, Azure DevOps, CI/CD, Git, Power BI, Jira, Scrum/Agile

Leadership & Delivery: Stakeholder Management, Cross-functional Collaboration, Technical Mentoring & Enablement, Requirements Gathering, Solution Design, UAT & Delivery Ownership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer Consultant, KPMG India	Apr 2025 – Present
Reduced monthly cloud compute spend from USD 12,000 to USD 8,400 by redesigning Synapse workspace segregation and consolidating Data Lake migrations, and moved roughly 75% of client workloads to Azure. - Designed and built an organization-wide Lakehouse platform and executive dashboard for a consulting client with around 15,000 employees, using Delta Lake models with optimized partitioning and incremental loads to enable faster, governed enterprise reporting. - Implemented Unity Catalog governance with fine-grained access controls and data lineage across Databricks workspaces, standardizing secure data access for client teams. Delivered 40+ manufacturing KPIs for inventory and operations visibility through Azure Synapse pipelines, achieving 100% UAT pass on the first iteration and meeting all delivery timelines. - Led a Microsoft Fabric proof-of-concept evaluating OneLake, Lakehouse, and Direct Lake; authored the architectural recommendation that secured stakeholder approval to migrate production pipelines and semantic models to Fabric. - Designed and ran an Azure and Databricks enablement program for 25+ colleagues, reaching about 80% adoption.	
Data Engineer Consultant, KPMG India	May 2022 – Mar 2025
Designed, built and maintained 100+ production ETL/ELT pipelines across Azure Data Factory, Azure Synapse, and Databricks, integrating complex on-premises and cloud sources into ADLS Gen2. Reduced query latency and compute cost by tuning PySpark and Delta Lake workloads with Z-Ordering, partitioning and data-skipping strategies while sustaining high-speed retrieval for enterprise analytics. - Delivered logistics KPIs for a healthcare client using Azure Synapse pipelines and Lakehouse storage, and built Databricks dashboard proof-of-concepts with MLflow to support early machine learning work. - Improved Power BI report and query performance by developing optimized data models within Azure Synapse Serverless and Dedicated SQL Pools. - Set up CI/CD across Dev, Test, and Production using Azure DevOps and Git, reducing manual deployment overhead and ensuring the stability of enterprise-grade data pipelines. - Built Databricks dashboard proof-of-concepts and implemented MLflow to support the client's early machine learning work. - Recognized as a Top 5 Learner in the Digital Lighthouse practice for 5+ advanced Azure and Databricks certifications.	
Consultant Trainee, KPMG India	Jan 2022 – May 2022
- Earned a Pre-Placement Offer (PPO) for high performance supporting Data Lake implementation and operations. - Built 15+ end-to-end Azure data pipelines and Power BI dashboards supporting executive decision-making.	

EDUCATION

M.Tech, Data Science, NMIMS University, Mumbai	CGPA 3.88 / 4.0	2020 – 2022
B.E., Computer Engineering, University of Mumbai	CGPA 8.55 / 10	2016 – 2020

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Fabric Data Engineer Associate (Jun 2025)
- Databricks Certified: Data Engineer Professional (Jul 2023)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Engineer Associate (Jun 2023)